

Mortuary Temple of Hatshepsut – ARCH 150 Assignment



Image 1: Mortuary Temple of Hatshepsut (Djeser-Djeseru), Deir el-Bahari, Egypt, ca. 1479–1458 BCE. The terraced temple is embedded into the cliffs, blending architecture with the desert landscape.



Image 2: The temple employs a post-and-lintel system with limestone columns supporting horizontal beams. This construction technique reflects Egyptian precision in axial design and monumental rhythm. Load-bearing colonnades created monumental terraces aligned along a central axis.



Image 3: Builders used locally quarried Theban limestone. Blocks were shaped, sometimes carved and painted. Natural materials were resourcefully adapted into structural and decorative forms. Some reliefs were brightly colored with mineral pigments, though others remained unfinished.



Image 4: Carved stone reliefs depict Hatshepsut's divine birth and offerings to Amun-Re. Durable stone and monumental scale conveyed her legitimacy, linking politics, religion, and permanence. The choice of material reflects Egyptian beliefs in eternal kingship and cosmic order.

Sources (Chicago Style):

"Mortuary Temple of Hatshepsut." Photograph. Encyclopædia Britannica. Image date unknown.

Model of the Temple of Hatshepsut. Photograph. Metropolitan Museum of Art, accession 2012.139.

Teresa Dziedzic. Photograph. "Research of the Theban limestone: the case of the Temple of Hatshepsut in Deir el-Bahari." E3S Web of Conferences 49 (2018).

Relief depicting divine birth scenes from the temple walls. Photograph. Wikipedia.